

COMPLETE SETUP & USAGE GUIDE

NotebookLM Study System

A start-to-finish framework for building a NotebookLM that actually prepares you for exams.

This system works in four phases: **Setup** (done in Claude before touching NotebookLM), **Unit Setup** (run once per unit), **Final Exam Prep** (run after all units are done), and **Exam Day** (the study sequence). Follow the phases in order. Save every output as a Note with the exact filename shown.

Setup — Do This in Claude First

1 Gather your source files

Collect everything for the class: textbook chapters, glossary/vocabulary lists, formula sheets, syllabus, sample tests, and practice questions.

2 Run the Master Index prompt in Claude

Open Claude and paste the Master Index Setup Prompt. Fill in your class name, number of units, number of chapters, and your folder path or file list. Claude will rename everything and generate your `00_MASTER_INDEX`.

3 Rename your files exactly as Claude recommends

Example: `DATA_U1_Intro_to_Biology.pdf` · `VOCAB_U1_Glossary.pdf` · `REF_Syllabus.pdf`

4 Create your NotebookLM notebook

Go to notebooklm.google.com and create a new notebook for this class.

5 Upload your files

Upload all renamed source files plus `00_MASTER_INDEX` and all `PROMPT_` files from your generated package.

6 Paste the system prompt

Click the NotebookLM instructions panel and paste the system prompt. Fill in your class name. Do not paste the Master Index into the prompt — the system finds `00_MASTER_INDEX` on its own.

Skipped Phase 1 or uploaded raw files? Run `PROMPT_Index` first by saying "Use `PROMPT_Index`." It audits every file in your notebook and outputs a structured report. Save that output as a Note, then bring it to Claude along with your existing `00_MASTER_INDEX`. Claude will merge the two, resolve any conflicts, and generate a clean updated index. Upload the new index to NotebookLM, delete the old one, and you're back on track — without ever losing your progress tracking.

Unit Setup — Repeat for Every Unit

Run these steps in order for each unit. Save every output as a Note using the exact title shown. Do not skip ahead — each step feeds the next.

STEP	GOAL	SAVE AS
1	Extraction pass	NOTES_U[#]_Extraction
2	Key concepts outline	NOTES_U[#]_Key_Concepts
3	Glossary	NOTES_U[#]_Glossary
4	Formula sheet	NOTES_U[#]_Formulas
5	Slide deck outline	NOTES_U[#]_Slide_Deck_Outline
6	Study notes	NOTES_U[#]_Study_Notes
7	Practice quiz	NOTES_U[#]_Practice_Quiz

How to save a Note: When output appears in chat, click the save icon or select "Save to Note" and type the exact title from the table above.

If NotebookLM asks "do you want to continue to the next item": Say yes if you are still on the same step. Start a fresh prompt from Step 1 when moving to a new unit.

Final Exam Prep — After All Units Are Done

Do not begin Phase 3 until every unit has all seven notes saved.

STEP	GOAL	SAVE AS
1	Master concept map	REVIEW_Master_Concept_Map
2	Master glossary	REVIEW_Master_Glossary
3	Master formula sheet	REVIEW_Master_Formulas
4	Weak spot report	REVIEW_Weak_Spot_Report
5	Final slide deck	REVIEW_Final_Slide_Deck_Outline
6	Cumulative study notes	REVIEW_Cumulative_Study_Notes
7	Cumulative practice exam	REVIEW_Cumulative_Practice_Exam

Exam Day Study Sequence

Work through these in order when it is time to study for the final.

1 REVIEW_Weak_Spot_Report

Find your gaps first. Get outside resources before doing anything else.

2 REVIEW_Final_Slide_Deck_Outline

Fast pass through the whole course.

3 REVIEW_Master_Glossary — CROSS-UNIT HIGH section only

These terms are almost certainly on your exam.

4 REVIEW_Master_Formulas — top section only

The most exam-likely formulas.

5 REVIEW_Cumulative_Practice_Exam

Take it timed with no notes.

6 Review wrong answers

For every incorrect answer go back to the relevant NOTES_U[#]_Study_Notes.

7 REVIEW_Cumulative_Study_Notes — final summary only

Read this the morning of the exam. Nothing else.

Quick Reference — File Naming

SOURCE FILES — YOU UPLOAD THESE

DATA_U[#]_

Textbook / study material by unit

DATA_C[#]_

Textbook / study material by chapter

VOCAB_U[#]_

Glossary by unit

VOCAB_C[#]_

Glossary by chapter

FORMULAS_U[#]_

Formula sheet by unit

FORMULAS_C[#]_

Formula sheet by chapter

REF_

Syllabus, weights, sample tests

00_MASTER_INDEX

The index of everything

PROMPT_Index

Run first if files are not renamed

GENERATED NOTES — SAVE INSIDE NOTEBOOKLM

NOTES_U[#]_Extraction

NOTES_U[#]_Key_Concepts

NOTES_U[#]_Glossary

NOTES_U[#]_Formulas

NOTES_U[#]_Slide_Deck_Outline

NOTES_U[#]_Study_Notes

NOTES_U[#]_Practice_Quiz

REVIEW_Master_Concept_Map

REVIEW_Master_Glossary

REVIEW_Master_Formulas

REVIEW_Weak_Spot_Report

REVIEW_Final_Slide_Deck_Outline

REVIEW_Cumulative_Study_Notes

REVIEW_Cumulative_Practice_Exam

RULES

The Three Rules

01

Always do Phase 2 in order

The extraction note feeds everything else. Skip it and every output that follows will be weaker.

02

Always save your outputs as Notes

If you skip the save step the system re-generates everything from scratch every time. The notes are the memory.

03

Finish all units before Phase 3

The cross-unit review only works if all unit notes exist. Do not start Phase 3 early.

Start in Claude · Build in NotebookLM · Study with a system notebooklm.google.com